misreporting. He clarified that, according to their policy, they met the foreign emissaries, especially from the UK or the US and Western countries, only after informing the government of Pakistan. This care was taken to avoid any allegation of having links with foreign powers, which was a common allegation hurled conveniently on anybody who met the foreign diplomats. Nazir Naji, however, insisted on the credibility of his source and authenticity of his information.

It was surmised that the American move might have been motivated by Hafiz Saeed's active presence in the Defense of Pakistan Council (DPC), a right-wing pressure group comprising jihadist militant groups, religious parties and conservative politicians, which had conducted major rallies in cities across Pakistan since January 2012. Its aim was to influence a major debate on Pakistan–US ties that was underway in parliament and, in particular, to prevent the reopening of NATO supply lines that had been closed since November 2011. DPC gathered a huge number of participants, and a tirade was set against India and the US, which alarmed Western diplomats and many Pakistanis. The media expressed suspicions that the DPC enjoyed tacit support from the military and the Inter-Services Intelligence Directorate, or ISI, possibly as a means of pressing Washington (Walsh, 2012). This speculation could be partially correct but was incorrect in that all components of DPC were being guided by the army or ISI. A JuD leader confided that the army was in favour of opening the NATO supplies, whereas the government of Pakistan wanted to take time to open it.

This whispering campaign was spread by the sponsored members of DPC. One such person had the reputation of being paid by a source of various local and foreign intelligence agencies. In fact, this campaign within DPC was sponsored but at least revealed that DPC was not moving entirely at the behest of the army or ISI. However, their influence on various components of DPC could not be ruled out. As far as JuD is concerned, 'it is claimed that its autonomy from the ISI has increased and it now requires only specific support – including safe havens, intelligence and campaign guidance rather than finances' (Sajjad, Hafeez & Firdous, 2010).

TRANSFORMATION

Transformation from LeT to JuD and in its stance and approach from known anti-India jihadi activities to a more political approach over the